

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The nature and purpose of Jewish public acts of worship: the nature, features and purpose of Jewish public worship, including interpretations of Psalms 116:12–19; the nature, features and importance of synagogue services for the Jewish community and the individual.
3.2	The Tenakh and the Talmud: the nature, features, purpose and significance of the Tenakh (the written law) and Talmud (the oral law) for Jews in daily life today with reference to Perkei Avot 2; the nature and purpose of Jewish laws food laws, kashrut, including kosher and treifah and the separation of dairy and meat, including reference to Deuteronomy 14:3–10; the divergent implications of the Jewish food laws for Jews today.
3.3	The nature and purpose of prayer in the home and of private prayer: the nature, features and purpose of prayer three times a day; the importance of having different forms of prayers, including interpretations of Psalms 55:16–23.
3.4*	The nature and importance of the Shema and the Amidah (the standing prayer); when the Shema and the Amidah might be used, how and why, including reference to the Mezuzah; the importance of having the Shema and the Amidah for Jews today, including reference to Deuteronomy 6:4.
3.5	The importance of ritual for Jews today: the nature, features and purpose of birth rituals (including Brit Milah), Bar and Bat Mitzvahs, and marriage rituals, including interpretations of Genesis 21:1–8, Genesis 17 and Leviticus 12; the nature, purpose and importance of the mourning rituals of funeral, shiva, avelut and yahrzeit for Jews today; divergent understandings of the importance of each ritual for different forms of Orthodox and Reform Judaism today.
3.6	The nature, features, history and purpose of celebrating Shabbat: the nature, features and purpose of the celebration of Shabbat in the home and in the synagogue, including interpretations of Exodus 31:12–18; why the celebration of Shabbat is important for the Jewish community and the individual today.
3.7	Jewish festivals: the nature, history, purpose and significance of Jewish festivals; the origins and meaning of specific festivals, including Rosh Hashanah, Yom Kippur, Pesach, Shavuot and Sukkot, including interpretations of Leviticus 23 (Rosh Hashanah); divergent understandings of why festivals are important to different forms of Orthodox and Reform Judaism today.
3.8	Features of the synagogue: the nature, history and purpose of the different design of the synagogues in Liberal, Reform and Orthodox Judaism, including facing Jerusalem, layout of seating the Ark and the bimah and with reference to Proverbs 14:28; how and why the synagogue is used by the different communities, including reference to Exodus 27:20–21; how and why objects of devotion are used within the synagogues, including a yad, Torah Scroll, ner tamid and menorah.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Jewish teachings about the origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Jewish responses to them, including reference to Genesis 1–3; the value of the universe in Jewish teaching; divergent Jewish responses to the possible view that the universe may be used as a commodity.
4.2	Jewish teachings about the value of life: how life is shown as special in the Tenakh, including reference to being created in the image of the Almighty as shown in Genesis 1–3; divergent Jewish teachings on the value of life; the significance of sanctity of life for Jews today.
4.3	Jewish responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins of human life, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, including Genesis 1:26–31; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Jews today.
4.4	Implications of the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: the nature of abortion; divergent Jewish teachings about abortion, including the Mishnah, Sanhedrin 4:5; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them.
4.5	Jewish teachings about life after death: Jewish teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death, including reference to Maimonides's 'Thirteen Principles of the Jewish Faith'; divergent Jewish arguments for life after death (remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones who have passed on); divergent understandings of the significance of belief in life after death in different Jewish traditions.
4.6	Jewish responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Jews may reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Isaiah 25.
4.7	Implications of the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: the nature of euthanasia; different Jewish teachings about euthanasia, including different interpretations of Judges 9:51–57; divergent Jewish, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Jewish responses to them, including support for hospice care.
4.8	Jewish responses to issues in the natural world: Jewish responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources; Jewish teachings about environmental care, specifically stewardship and humanity's role as stewards, including reference to Psalm 24:1–3 and The Jewish Declaration on Nature – Assisi 1986; divergent Jewish responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, including the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.

Area of Study 1G – Sikhism

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Sikhism as a lived religion within the United Kingdom and throughout the world, and its beliefs and teachings on life, specifically within families, and with regard to matters of life and death.

There are four sections: Sikh Beliefs, Marriage and the Family, Living the Sikh Life and Matters of Life and Death.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices to Sikhs today should be explored throughout the sections. This should include reference to how scripture informs a Sikh's understanding of the topics and how approaches to the issues are underpinned by philosophical arguments and ethical theory as applicable.

Students will be expected to study Sikhism within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Sikhism with Christianity as outlined in the content below.

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.4)*
- The practice and significance of worship (3.5)*

Students should recognise that Sikhism is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Judaism, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of ethics and/or philosophy within Sikhism and non-religious views as outlined in the content below.

Students should also recognise that within Sikhism there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Sikhism in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Khalsa and non-Khalsa Sikhs.